



# Hi-Points

**HP's Consumer Fall Launch in Singapore, September 2007**

Around this time every year, HP's newest products find themselves under the same roof, being poked and prodded at by the media (that's us) before they're let loose upon the population. We've given the lot a whirl, though their true worth will only come out when our test centre's had its turn.

## Raining iPAQs

This was also the largest ever launch of iPAQ handhelds ever—five new iPAQs will hit the markets in the coming months. The iPAQ 212 Enterprise Handheld boasts a sharp 4-inch VGA touchscreen that renders text clearly at the tiniest sizes, and is the ideal for professionals on the move. The iPAQ 612 Business Navigator is the ultimate converged device—quad-band GSM, HSDPA, Wi-Fi (802.11 b/g), 3-megapixel camera, GPS navigation—all in a diminutive package. It also sports an iPod-like “smart-touch” navigation scheme using the raised ring on the keypad, apart from the touchscreen and scroll wheel. All the iPAQs run on Windows Mobile 6, complete with the new Office Mobile.



## Media Centre For The Elite



First off the pad is what might prove to be the ultimate media centre PC—the HP Pavilion Elite m9000. It's for the “Digital Elite”—read for those with money to throw away; it's \$3,299 (close to Rs 1,40,000) for the works, and packs in an Intel Core 2 Quad Q6600, 2 GB of RAM, a terabyte of storage and a Blu-ray / HD-DVD Combo drive. The entire package looks sweet, but you know how glossy black surfaces beg for fingerprints—keep your cleaning cloth handy. You can enjoy your movies on the beautiful 22-inch LCD, but forget about high-end gaming—the m9000 comes with a comparatively anaemic 8600GT graphics card. Not so elite, that.

## All (Literally) In One!



The HP Photosmart C8188 is the mother of all MFDs (or All-in-ones, as HP calls them), and comes at a price of \$400 (little over Rs 16,000), which is a small price to pay for what it's capable of. It'll take photos from your camera's flash memory and print them in six-colour, smudge- and water-resistant glory, archive them to a CD or DVD using the built-in LightScribe DVD-Writer, and etch them on to LightScribe discs. It'll also scan documents, images and even negatives at 4800 x 4800 dpi, and connect to just about anything, using Wi-Fi or Bluetooth. The new touchscreen interface (to be seen on many new printers and MFDs from HP) is ridiculously easy to use, and it took just over a minute for us to go from picture-on-memory-card to glossy-print-in-hand.